PDF Lite

A lightweight, Acrobat-style PDF reader for Windows.

This built-in sample demonstrates continuous scrolling, text selection, search, bookmarks, thumbnails, rotation and full-screen reading.

Try Ctrl+F and search for the word 'lightweight'. Use the Bookmarks tab to jump between sections. Drag across text to select it, then press Ctrl+C.

Keyboard essentials

Ctrl+O	Open a PDF
Ctrl+F	Find text
Ctrl+G	Go to a page
Ctrl++/-	Zoom in or out
Ctrl+1	Actual size
F11	Full screen
F4	Show or hide the sidebar

1. Reading and navigation

PDF Lite uses a continuous page view, just like Acrobat Reader. Scroll with the mouse wheel, Page Up/Down, or the scrollbar. The page box in the toolbar accepts a page number.

The back/forward buttons remember page jumps during the current session. Acrobat's page controls remain familiar: First, Previous, Next and Last.

View modes

Fit Width	Fill the window width with the current page.
Fit Page	Show the entire current page.
Actual Size	Return to 100% zoom.

When you resize the window while Fit Width or Fit Page is active, the page is re-fitted automatically.

2. Selecting and copying text

PDF Lite has a text tool that works on normal, selectable PDFs. Press the left mouse button inside a page and drag across the text. Selected words are highlighted in blue. Press Ctrl+C to copy the selection, or right-click for a context menu.

Select All on Page copies every word on the visible page. Copy Page Text does the same through the Edit menu.

Scanned PDFs may contain only images. Those documents need OCR before their text can be selected; PDF Lite intentionally stays lightweight and does not bundle an OCR engine.

Selection clears when you zoom or rotate, which prevents highlight positions from drifting.

3. Finding text

Press Ctrl+F or click Find in the toolbar. Type a word or phrase and press Enter. PDF Lite searches the whole document in a background thread and highlights every match.

Use Next and Previous to step through matches. The current match is shown in red; all other matches are yellow. Matching ignores case, like Acrobat Reader.

Search example: the word 'lightweight' appears in this document more than once. Search for 'rotation' to test navigation across pages.

4. Bookmarks and thumbnails

F4 toggles the left sidebar. The Pages tab shows live page thumbnails and the Bookmarks tab shows the PDF outline. Click either one to jump to that page.

This sample PDF contains an embedded outline, so the Bookmarks tab is populated. Many PDFs do not include bookmarks; in that case PDF Lite shows a short explanation and the page field and navigation buttons remain available.

5. Appearance and display

Use View > Dark Mode to switch the application chrome between light and dark. PDF pages themselves keep their original white background, which matches the readable behavior of Acrobat.

Page rotation is available under View. Rotate the whole document clockwise or counter-clockwise, and reset it at any time.

F11 enters full-screen mode. Escape leaves it.

6. A page for searching

lightweight reader
lightweight rendering
lightweight startup

Search for 'lightweight' on this page to see several hits grouped close together. Use Next to move through each rectangle.

The status bar reports page number, zoom, page count and file size. Long documents scroll continuously and render only the pages near the viewport, keeping memory use modest.

7. File properties and help

File > Properties shows title, author, subject, keywords, producer, page count and file size.

This program is a source-based alternative for everyday reading. It does not edit, sign, redact or fill PDF forms. For those workflows, keep Adobe Acrobat or another dedicated editor.

Close the document with Ctrl+W. Open another PDF with Ctrl+O.

A note about PDF support
PDF is a complex format. This reader covers common reading workflows rather than every optional PDF feature. Encrypted files are supported when you know the password.